

80 Plus efficiency	ICON	Rated load percentage			
		10%	20%	50%	100%
80 Plus			80%	80%	80%
80 Plus Bronze			82%	85%	82%
80 Plus Silver			85%	88%	85%
80 Plus Gold			87%	90%	87%
80 Plus Platinum			90%	92%	89%
80 Plus Titanium		90%	92%	94%	90%

When choosing a PSU, look for the certification badge on the box. Also consider Cybenetics' ETA ratings for efficiency and LAMBDA ratings for noise levels. These newer standards provide more granular insight into real-world performance and can help differentiate between models with similar 80 PLUS ratings.

Modular vs Semi-Modular vs Non-Modular

Cable management affects airflow, aesthetics and upgrade flexibility. Modular PSUs allow you to connect only the cables you need, reducing clutter and improving airflow. Seasonic notes that modular cables are easy to replace and promote better

ventilation. Semi-modular units have fixed main cables (24-pin and CPU) with the rest detachable. Non-modular PSUs have all cables permanently attached, which can hinder airflow and make cable management more challenging.

Choosing Modularity

- **Fully modular:** Ideal for clean builds, small cases and frequent upgrades. Brands like Corsair HX Series, Seasonic PRIME and Thermaltake Toughpower GF3 are fully modular.
- **Semi-modular:** Good compromise between cost and flexibility. Units like Cooler Master MWE Gold or DeepCool PQ-M have fixed motherboard and CPU cables but detachable PCIe and SATA cables.